[8] If a case is too difficult for you to judge, whether the controversy within your gates is regarding bloodshed, lawsuits, or assaults, you must go up to the place the LORD your God will choose. [9] You are to go to the Levitical priests and to the judge who presides at that time. Inquire of them, and they will give you a verdict in the case.

[10] You must abide by the verdict they give you at the place the LORD will choose. Be careful to do everything they instruct you, [11] according to the terms of law they give and the verdict they proclaim. Do not turn aside to the right or to the left from the decision they declare to you. [12] But the man who acts presumptuously, refusing to listen either to the priest who stands there to serve the LORD your God, or to the judge, must be put to death. You must purge the evil from Israel. [13] Then all the people will hear and be afraid, and will no longer behave arrogantly. [14] When you enter the land that the LORD your God is giving you and have taken possession of it and settled in it, and you say, "Let us set a king over us like all the nations around us," [15] you are to appoint over yourselves the king whom the LORD your God shall choose. Appoint a king from among your brothers; you are not to set over yourselves a foreigner who is not one of your brothers. [16] But the king must not acquire many horses for himself or send the people back to Egypt to acquire more horses, for the LORD has said, 'You are never to go back that way again.' [17] He must not take many wives for himself, lest his heart go astray. He must not accumulate for himself large amounts of silver and gold. [18] When he is seated on his royal throne, he must write for himself a copy of this instruction on a scroll in the presence of the Levitical priests. [19] It is to remain with him, and he is to read from it all the days of his life, so that he may learn to fear the LORD his God by carefully observing all the words of this instruction and these statutes. [20] Then his heart will not be exalted above his countrymen, and he will not turn aside from the commandment, to the right or to the left, in order that he and his sons may reign many years over his kingdom in Israel.

**18** The Levitical priests—indeed the whole tribe of Levi—shall have no portion or inheritance with Israel. They are to eat the offerings made by fire to the LORD; that is their inheritance. [2] Although they have no inheritance among their brothers, the LORD is their inheritance, as He promised them. [3] This shall be the priests' share from the people who offer a sacrifice, whether a bull or a sheep: the priests are to be given the shoulder, the jowls, and the stomach. [4] You are to give them the firstfruits of your grain, new wine, and oil, and the first wool sheared from your flock. [5] For the LORD your God has chosen Levi and his sons out of all your tribes to stand and minister in His name for all time. [6] Now if a Levite moves from any town of residence throughout Israel and comes in all earnestness to the place the LORD will choose, [7] then he shall serve in the name of the LORD his God like all his fellow Levites who stand there before the LORD. [8] They shall eat equal portions, even though he has received money from the sale of his father's estate. [9] When you enter the land that the LORD your God is giving you, do not imitate the detestable ways of the nations there.

[10] Let no one be found among you who sacrifices his son or daughter in the fire, practices divination or conjury, interprets omens, practices sorcery, [11] casts spells, consults a medium or spiritist, or inquires of the dead. [12] For whoever does these things is detestable to the LORD. And because of these detestable things, the LORD your God is driving out the nations before you. [13] You must be blameless before the LORD your God.

[14] Though these nations, which you will dispossess, listen to conjurers and diviners, the LORD your God has not permitted you to do so. [15] The LORD your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your brothers. You must listen to him. [16] This is what you asked of the LORD your God at Horeb on the day of the assembly, when you said, "Let us not hear the voice of the LORD our God or see this great fire anymore, so that we will not die!" [17] Then the LORD said to me, "They have spoken well." [18] I will raise up for them a prophet like you from among their brothers. I will put My words in his mouth, and he will tell them everything I command him. [19] And I will hold accountable anyone who does not listen to My words that the prophet speaks in My name. [20] "But if any prophet dares to speak a message in My name that I have not commanded him to speak, or to speak in the name of other gods, that prophet must be put to death." [21] You may ask in your heart, "How can we recognize a message that the LORD has not spoken?" [22] When a prophet speaks in the name of the LORD and the message does not come to pass or come true, that is a message the LORD has not spoken. The prophet has spoken presumptuously. Do not be afraid of him.

**19** When the LORD your God has cut off the nations whose land He is giving you, and when you have driven them out and settled in their cities and houses, [2] then you are to set apart for yourselves three cities within the land that the LORD your God is giving you to possess. [3] You are to build roads for yourselves and divide into three regions the land that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, so that any manslayer can flee to these cities. [4] Now this is the situation regarding the manslayer who flees to one of these cities to save his life, having killed his neighbor accidentally, without intending to harm him: [5] If he goes into the forest with his neighbor to cut timber and swings his axe to chop down a tree, but the blade flies off the handle and strikes and kills his neighbor, he may flee to one of these cities to save his life. [6] Otherwise, the avenger of blood might pursue the manslayer in a rage, overtake him if the distance is great, and strike him dead though he did not deserve to die, since he did not intend any harm.

[7] This is why I am commanding you to set apart for yourselves three cities. [8] And if the LORD your God enlarges your territory, as He swore to your fathers, and gives you all the land He promised them, [9] and if you carefully keep all these commandments I am giving you today, loving the LORD your God and walking in His ways at all times, then you are to add three more cities to these three. [10] Thus innocent blood will not be shed in the land that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, so that you will not be guilty of bloodshed.

[11] If, however, a man hates his neighbor and lies in wait, attacks him and kills him, and then flees to one of these cities, [12] the elders of his city must send for him, bring him back, and hand him over to the avenger of blood to die. [13] You must show him no pity. You are to purge from Israel the guilt of shedding innocent blood, that it may go well with you.

[14] You must not move your neighbor's boundary marker, which was set up by your ancestors to mark the inheritance you shall receive in the land that the LORD your God is giving you to possess. [15] A lone witness is not sufficient to establish any wrongdoing or sin against a man, regardless of what offense he may have committed. A matter must be established by the testimony of two or three witnesses. [16] If a false witness testifies against someone, accusing him of a crime, [17] both parties to the dispute must stand in the presence of the LORD, before the priests and judges who are in office at that time. [18] The judges shall investigate thoroughly, and if the witness is proven to be a liar who has falsely accused his brother, [19] you must do to him as he intended to do to his brother. So you must purge the evil from among you. [20] Then the rest of the people will hear and be afraid, and they will never again do anything so evil among you. [21] You must show no pity: life for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, and foot for foot.

**20** When you go out to war against your enemies and see horses, chariots, and an army larger than yours, do not be afraid of them; for the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, is with you. [2] When you are about to go into battle, the priest is to come forward and address the army, [3] saying to them, "Hear, O Israel, today you are going into battle with your enemies. Do not be fainthearted or afraid; do not be alarmed or terrified because of them." [4] "For the LORD your God goes with you to fight for you against your enemies, to give you the victory." [5] Furthermore, the officers are to address the army, saying, "Has any man built a new house and not dedicated it? Let him return home, or he may die in battle and another man dedicate it." [6] Has any man planted a vineyard and not begun to enjoy its fruit? Let him return home, or he may die in battle and another man enjoy its fruit. [7] "Has any man become pledged to a woman and not married her? Let him return home, or he may die in battle and another man marry her." [8] Then the officers shall speak further to the army, saying, "Is any man afraid or fainthearted? Let him return home, so that the hearts of his brothers will not melt like his own." [9] When the officers have finished addressing the army, they are to appoint commanders to lead it. [10] When you approach a city to fight against it, you are to make an offer of peace. [11] If they accept your offer of peace and open their gates, all the people there will become forced laborers to serve you. [12] But if they refuse to make peace with you and wage war against you, lay siege to that city. [13] When the LORD your God has delivered it into your hand, you must put every male to the sword. [14] But the women, children, livestock, and whatever else is in the city—all its spoil—you may take as plunder, and you shall use the spoil of your enemies that the LORD your God gives you.

[15] This is how you are to treat all the cities that are far away from you and do not belong to the nations nearby. [16] However, in the cities of the nations that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, you must not leave alive anything that breathes. [17] For you must devote them to complete destruction —the Hittites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites—as the LORD your God has commanded you, [18] so that they cannot teach you to do all the detestable things they do for their gods, and so cause you to sin against the LORD your God. [19] When you lay siege to a city for an extended time while fighting against it to capture it, you must not destroy its trees by putting an axe to them, because you can eat their fruit. You must not cut them down. Are the trees of the field human, that you should besiege them? [20] But you may destroy the trees that you know do not produce fruit. Use them to build siege works against the city that is waging war against you, until it falls.

**21** If one is found slain, lying in a field in the land that the LORD your God is giving you to possess, and it is not known who killed him, [2] your elders and judges must come out and measure the distance from the victim to the neighboring cities. [3] Then the elders of the city nearest the victim shall take a heifer that has never been yoked or used for work, [4] bring the heifer to a valley with running water that has not been plowed or sown, and break its neck there by the stream. [5] And the priests, the sons of Levi, shall come forward, for the LORD your God has chosen them to serve Him and pronounce blessings in His name and to give a ruling in every dispute and case of assault. [6] Then all the elders of the city nearest the victim shall wash their hands by the stream over the heifer whose neck has been broken, [7] and they shall declare, "Our hands did not shed this blood, nor did our eyes see it." [8] "Accept this atonement, O LORD, for Your people Israel whom You have redeemed, and do not hold the shedding of innocent blood against them." And the bloodshed will be atoned for. [9] So you shall purge from among you the guilt of shedding innocent blood, since you have

done what is right in the eyes of the LORD. [10] When you go to war against your enemies and the LORD your God delivers them into your hand and you take them captive, [11] if you see a beautiful woman among them, and you desire her and want to take her as your wife, [12] then you shall bring her into your house. She must shave her head, trim her nails, [13] and put aside the clothing of her captivity. After she has lived in your house a full month and mourned her father and mother, you may have relations with her and be her husband, and she shall be your wife.

[14] And if you are not pleased with her, you are to let her go wherever she wishes. But you must not sell her for money or treat her as a slave, since you have dishonored her.

[15] If a man has two wives, one beloved and the other unloved, and both bear him sons, but the unloved wife has the firstborn son, [16] when that man assigns his inheritance to his sons he must not appoint the son of the beloved wife as the firstborn over the son of the unloved wife. [17] Instead, he must acknowledge the firstborn, the son of his unloved wife, by giving him a double portion of all that he has. For that son is the firstfruits of his father's strength; the right of the firstborn belongs to him. [18] If a man has a stubborn and rebellious son who does not obey his father and mother and does not listen to them when disciplined, [19] his father and mother are to lay hold of him and bring him to the elders of his city, to the gate of his hometown, [20] and say to the elders, "This son of ours is stubborn and rebellious; he does not obey us. He is a glutton and a drunkard." [21] Then all the men of his city will stone him to death. So you must purge the evil from among you, and all Israel will hear and be afraid. [22] If a man has committed a sin worthy of death, and he is executed, and you hang his body on a tree, [23] you must not leave the body on the tree overnight, but you must be sure to bury him that day, because anyone who is hung on a tree is under God's curse. You must not defile the land that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance.

**22** If you see your brother's ox or sheep straying, you must not ignore it; be sure to return it to your brother. [2] If your brother does not live near you, or if you do not know who he is, you are to take the animal home to remain with you until your brother comes seeking it; then you can return it to him. [3] And you shall do the same for his donkey, his cloak, or anything your brother has lost and you have found. You must not ignore it. [4] If you see your brother's donkey or ox fallen on the road, you must not ignore it; you must help him lift it up. [5] A woman must not wear men's clothing, and a man must not wear women's clothing, for whoever does these things is detestable to the LORD your God. [6] If you come across a bird's nest with chicks or eggs, either in a tree or on the ground along the road, and the mother is sitting on the chicks or eggs, you must not take the mother along with the young. [7] You may take the young, but be sure to let the mother go, so that it may be well with you and that you may prolong your days. [8] If you build a new house, you are to construct a railing around your roof, so that you do not bring bloodguilt on your house if someone falls from it. [9] Do not plant your vineyard with two types of seed; if you do, the entire harvest will be defiled—both the crop you plant and the fruit of your vineyard.

[10] Do not plow with an ox and a donkey yoked together. [11] Do not wear clothes of wool and linen woven together. [12] You are to make tassels on the four corners of the cloak you wear. [13] Suppose a man marries a woman, has relations with her, and comes to hate her, [14] and he then accuses her of shameful conduct and gives her a bad name, saying, "I married this woman and had relations with her, but I discovered she was not a virgin." [15] Then the young woman's father and mother shall bring the proof of her virginity to the city elders at the gate [16] and say to the elders, "I gave my daughter in marriage to this man, but he has come to hate her." [17] "And now he has accused her of shameful conduct, saying, 'I discovered that your daughter was not a virgin.' But here is the proof of her virginity." And they shall spread out the cloth before the city elders.

[18] Then the elders of that city shall take the man and punish him. [19] They are also to fine him a hundred shekels of silver and give them to the young woman's father, because this man has given a virgin of Israel a bad name. And she shall remain his wife; he must not divorce her as long as he lives.

[20] If, however, this accusation is true, and no proof of the young woman's virginity can be found, [21] she shall be brought to the door of her father's house, and there the men of her city will stone her to death. For she has committed an outrage in Israel by being promiscuous in her father's house. So you must purge the evil from among you. [22] If a man is found lying with another man's wife, both the man who slept with her and the woman must die. You must purge the evil from Israel. [23] If there is a virgin pledged in marriage to a man, and another man encounters her in the city and sleeps with her, [24] you must take both of them out to the gate of that city and stone them to death—the young woman because she did not cry out in the city, and the man because he has violated his neighbor's wife. So you must purge the evil from among you. [25] But if the man encounters a betrothed woman in the open country, and he overpowers her and lies with her, only the man who has done this must die. [26] Do nothing to the young woman, because she has committed no sin worthy of death. This case is just like one in which a man attacks his neighbor and murders him. [27] When he found her in the field, the betrothed woman cried out, but there was no one to save her. [28] If a man encounters a virgin who is not pledged in marriage, and he seizes her and lies with her, and they are discovered, [29] then the man who lay with her must pay the young woman's father fifty shekels of silver, and she must become his wife because he has violated her. He must not divorce her as long as he lives. [30] A man is not to marry his father's wife, so that he will not dishonor his father's marriage bed.

**23** No man with crushed or severed genitals may enter the assembly of the LORD. [2] No one of illegitimate birth may enter the assembly of the LORD, nor may any of his descendants, even to the tenth generation. [3] No Ammonite or Moabite or any of their descendants may enter the assembly of the LORD, even to the tenth generation. [4] For they did not meet you with food and water on your way out of Egypt, and they hired Balaam son of Beor from Pethor in Aram-naharaim to curse you. [5] Yet the LORD your God would not listen to Balaam, and the LORD your God turned the curse into a blessing for you, because the LORD your God loves you. [6] You are not to seek peace or prosperity from them as long as you live. [7] Do not despise an Edomite, for he is your brother. Do not despise an Egyptian, because you lived as a foreigner in his land.

[8] The third generation of children born to them may enter the assembly of the LORD. [9] When you are encamped against your enemies, then you shall keep yourself from every wicked thing. [10] If any man among you becomes unclean because of a nocturnal emission, he must leave the camp and stay outside. [11] When evening approaches, he must wash with water, and when the sun sets he may return to the camp.

[12] You must have a place outside the camp to go and relieve yourself. [13] And you must have a digging tool in your equipment so that when you relieve yourself you can dig a hole and cover up your excrement. [14] For the LORD your God walks throughout your camp to protect you and deliver your enemies to you. Your camp must be holy, lest He see anything unclean among you and turn away from you. [15] Do not return a slave to his master if he has taken refuge with you.

[16] Let him live among you wherever he chooses, in the town of his pleasing. Do not oppress him. [17] No daughter or son of Israel is to be a shrine prostitute. [18] You must not bring the wages of a prostitute, whether female or male, into the house of the LORD your God to fulfill any vow, because both are detestable to the LORD your God. [19] Do not charge your brother interest on money, food, or any other type of loan. [20] You may charge a foreigner interest, but not your brother, so that the LORD your God may bless you in everything to which you put your hand in the land that you are entering to possess. [21] If you make a vow to the LORD your God, do not be slow to keep it, because He will surely require it of you, and you will be guilty of sin. [22] But if you refrain from making a vow, you will not be guilty of sin. [23] Be careful to follow through on what comes from your lips, because you have freely vowed to the LORD your God with your own mouth. [24] When you enter your neighbor's vineyard, you may eat your fill of grapes, but you must not put any in your basket. [25] When you enter your neighbor's grainfield, you may pluck the heads of grain with your hand, but you must not put a sickle to your neighbor's grain.

**24** If a man marries a woman, but she becomes displeasing to him because he finds some indecency in her, he may write her a certificate of divorce, hand it to her, and send her away from his house. [2] If, after leaving his house, she goes and becomes another man's wife, [3] and the second man hates her, writes her a certificate of divorce, hands it to her, and sends her away from his house, or if he dies, [4] then the husband who divorced her first may not remarry her after she has been defiled, for that is an abomination to the LORD. You must not bring sin upon the land that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance. [5] If a man is newly married, he must not be sent to war or be pressed into any duty. For one year he is free to stay at home and bring joy to the wife he has married. [6] Do not take a pair of millstones or even an upper millstone as security for a debt, because that would be taking one's livelihood as security.

[7] If a man is caught kidnapping one of his Israelite brothers, whether he treats him as a slave or sells him, the kidnapper must die. So you must purge the evil from among you. [8] In cases of infectious skin diseases, be careful to diligently follow everything the Levitical priests instruct you. Be careful to do as I have commanded them. [9] Remember what the LORD your God did to Miriam on the journey after you came out of Egypt.

[10] When you lend anything to your neighbor, do not enter his house to collect security. [11] You are to stand outside while the man to whom you are lending brings the security out to you. [12] If he is a poor man, you must not go to sleep with the security in your possession; [13] be sure to return it to him by sunset, so that he may sleep in his own cloak and bless you, and this will be credited to you as righteousness before the LORD your God.

[14] Do not oppress a hired hand who is poor and needy, whether he is a brother or a foreigner residing in one of your towns. [15] You are to pay his wages each day before sunset, because he is poor and depends on them. Otherwise he may cry out to the LORD against you, and you will be guilty of sin. [16] Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin. [17] Do not deny justice to the foreigner or the fatherless, and do not take a widow's cloak as security. [18] Remember that you were slaves in Egypt, and the LORD your God redeemed you from that place. Therefore I am commanding you to do this. [19] If you are harvesting in your field and forget a sheaf there, do not go back to get it. It is to be left for the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow, so that the LORD your God may bless you in all the work of your hands. [20] When you beat the olives from your trees, you must not go over the branches again. What remains will be for the foreigner, the fatherless, and

the widow. [21] When you gather the grapes of your vineyard, you must not go over the vines again. What remains will be for the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow. [22] Remember that you were slaves in the land of Egypt. Therefore I am commanding you to do this.

**25** If there is a dispute between men, they are to go to court to be judged, so that the innocent may be acquitted and the guilty condemned. [2] If the guilty man deserves to be beaten, the judge shall have him lie down and be flogged in his presence with the number of lashes his crime warrants. [3] He may receive no more than forty lashes, lest your brother be beaten any more than that and be degraded in your sight. [4] Do not muzzle an ox while it is treading out the grain. [5] When brothers dwell together and one of them dies without a son, the widow must not marry outside the family. Her husband's brother is to take her as his wife and fulfill the duty of a brother-in-law for her. [6] The first son she bears will carry on the name of the dead brother, so that his name will not be blotted out from Israel. [7] But if the man does not want to marry his brother's widow, she is to go to the elders at the city gate and say, "My husband's brother refuses to preserve his brother's name in Israel. He is not willing to perform the duty of a brother-in-law for me."

[8] Then the elders of his city shall summon him and speak with him. If he persists and says, "I do not want to marry her," [9] his brother's widow shall go up to him in the presence of the elders, remove his sandal, spit in his face, and declare, "This is what is done to the man who will not maintain his brother's line." [10] And his family name in Israel will be called "The House of the Unsandaled." [11] If two men are fighting, and the wife of one steps in to rescue her husband from the one striking him, and she reaches out her hand and grabs his genitals, [12] you are to cut off her hand. You must show her no pity. [13] You shall not have two differing weights in your bag, one heavy and one light. [14] You shall not have two differing measures in your house, one large and one small. [15] You must maintain accurate and honest weights and measures, so that you may live long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you. [16] For everyone who behaves dishonestly in regard to these things is detestable to the LORD your God. [17] Remember what the Amalekites did to you along your way from Egypt, [18] how they met you on your journey when you were tired and weary, and they attacked all your stragglers; they had no fear of God. [19] When the LORD your God gives you rest from the enemies around you in the land that He is giving you to possess as an inheritance, you are to blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven. Do not forget!

**26** When you enter the land that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, and you take possession of it and settle in it, [2] you are to take some of the firstfruits of all your produce from the soil of the land that the LORD your God is giving you and put them in a basket. Then go to the place the LORD your God will choose as a dwelling for His Name, [3] to the priest who is serving at that time, and say to him, "I declare today to the LORD your God that I have entered the land that the LORD swore to our fathers to give us." [4] Then the priest shall take the basket from your hands and place it before the altar of the LORD your God, [5] and you are to declare before the LORD your God, "My father was a wandering Aramean, and he went down to Egypt few in number and lived there and became a great nation, mighty and numerous." [6] But the Egyptians mistreated us and afflicted us, putting us to hard labor. [7] So we called out to the LORD, the God of our fathers; and the LORD heard our voice and saw our affliction, toil, and oppression. [8] Then the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm, with great terror, signs, and wonders. [9] And He brought us to this place and gave us this land, a land flowing with milk and honey.

[10] "And now, behold, I have brought the firstfruits of the land that You, O LORD, have given me." Then you are to place the basket before the LORD your God and bow down before Him. [11] So you shall rejoice—you, the Levite, and the foreigner dwelling among you—in all the good things the LORD your God has given to you and your household. [12] When you have finished laying aside a tenth of all your produce in the third year, the year of the tithe, you are to give it to the Levite, the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow, that they may eat and be filled within your gates. [13] Then you shall declare in the presence of the LORD your God, "I have removed from my house the sacred portion and have given it to the Levite, the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow, according to all the commandments You have given me. I have not transgressed or forgotten Your commandments." [14] I have not eaten any of the sacred portion while in mourning, or removed any of it while unclean, or offered any of it for the dead. I have obeyed the LORD my God; I have done everything You commanded me. [15] "Look down from Your holy habitation, from heaven, and bless Your people Israel and the land You have given us as You swore to our fathers—a land flowing with milk and honey." [16] The LORD your God commands you this day to follow these statutes and ordinances. You must be careful to follow them with all your heart and with all your soul. [17] Today you have proclaimed that the LORD is your God and that you will walk in His ways, keep His statutes and commandments and ordinances, and listen to His voice. [18] And today the LORD has proclaimed that you are His people and treasured possession as He promised, that you are to keep all His commandments, [19] that He will set you high in praise and name and honor above all the nations He has made, and that you will be a holy people to the LORD your God, as He has promised.

**27** Then Moses and the elders of Israel commanded the people: "Keep all the commandments I am giving you today." [2] And on the day you cross the Jordan into the land that the LORD your God is giving you, set up large stones and coat them with plaster. [3] Write on them all the words of this law when you have crossed over to enter the land that the LORD your God is giving you, a land flowing with milk and honey, just as the LORD, the God of your fathers, has promised you. [4] And when you have crossed the Jordan, you are to set up these stones on Mount Ebal, as I am commanding you today, and you are to coat them with plaster. [5] Moreover, you are to build there an altar to the LORD your God, an altar of stones. You must not use any iron tool on them. [6] You shall build the altar of the LORD your God with uncut stones and offer upon it burnt offerings to the LORD your God. [7] There you are to sacrifice your peace offerings, eating them and rejoicing in the presence of the LORD your God.

[8] "And you shall write distinctly upon these stones all the words of this law." [9] Then Moses and the Levitical priests spoke to all Israel: "Be silent, O Israel, and listen! This day you have become the people of the LORD your God." [10] "You shall therefore obey the voice of the LORD your God and follow His commandments and statutes I am giving you today." [11] On that day Moses commanded the people: [12] "When you have crossed the Jordan, these tribes shall stand on Mount Gerizim to bless the people: Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Joseph, and Benjamin."

[13] And these tribes shall stand on Mount Ebal to deliver the curse: Reuben, Gad, Asher, Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali. [14] Then the Levites shall proclaim in a loud voice to every Israelite: [15] 'Cursed is the man who makes a carved idol or molten image—an abomination to the LORD, the work of the hands of a craftsman—and sets it up in secret.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [16] 'Cursed is he who dishonors his father or mother.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!'

[17] 'Cursed is he who moves his neighbor's boundary stone.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [18] 'Cursed is he who lets a blind man wander in the road.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [19] 'Cursed is he who withholds justice from the foreigner, the fatherless, or the widow.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [20] 'Cursed is he who sleeps with his father's wife, for he has violated his father's marriage bed.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [21] 'Cursed is he who lies with any animal.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [22] 'Cursed is he who sleeps with his sister, the daughter of his father or the daughter of his mother.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [23] 'Cursed is he who sleeps with his mother-in-law.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [24] 'Cursed is he who strikes down his neighbor in secret.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [25] 'Cursed is he who accepts a bribe to kill an innocent person.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!' [26] 'Cursed is he who does not put the words of this law into practice.' And let all the people say, 'Amen!'

**28** "Now if you faithfully obey the voice of the LORD your God and are careful to follow all His commandments I am giving you today, the LORD your God will set you high above all the nations of the earth." [2] And all these blessings will come upon you and overtake you, if you will obey the voice of the LORD your God: [3] You will be blessed in the city and blessed in the country. [4] The fruit of your womb will be blessed, as well as the produce of your land and the offspring of your livestock— the calves of your herds and the lambs of your flocks. [5] Your basket and kneading bowl will be blessed. [6] You will be blessed when you come in and blessed when you go out. [7] The LORD will cause the enemies who rise up against you to be defeated before you. They will march out against you in one direction but flee from you in seven. [8] The LORD will decree a blessing on your barns and on everything to which you put your hand; the LORD your God will bless you in the land He is giving you. [9] The LORD will establish you as His holy people, just as He has sworn to you, if you keep the commandments of the LORD your God and walk in His ways. [10] Then all the peoples of the earth will see that you are called by the name of the LORD, and they will stand in awe of you. [11] The LORD will make you prosper abundantly—in the fruit of your womb, the offspring of your livestock, and the produce of your land—in the land that the LORD swore to your fathers to give you. [12] The LORD will open the heavens, His abundant storehouse, to send rain on your land in season and to bless all the work of your hands. You will lend to many nations, but borrow from none. [13] The LORD will make you the head and not the tail; you will only move upward and never downward, if you hear and carefully follow the commandments of the LORD your God, which I am giving you today. [14] Do not turn aside to the right or to the left from any of the words I command you today, and do not go after other gods to serve them. [15] If, however, you do not obey the LORD your God by carefully following all His commandments and statutes I am giving you today, all these curses will come upon you and overtake you: [16] You will be cursed in the city and cursed in the country. [17] Your basket and kneading bowl will be cursed. [18] The fruit of your womb will be cursed, as well as the produce of your land, the calves of your herds, and the lambs of your flocks. [19] You will be cursed when you come in and cursed when you go out. [20] The LORD will send curses upon you, confusion and reproof in all to which you put your hand, until you are destroyed and quickly perish because of the wickedness you have committed in forsaking Him. [21] The LORD will make the plague cling to you until He has exterminated you from the land that you are entering to possess.

[22] The LORD will strike you with wasting disease, with fever and inflammation, with scorching heat and drought, and with blight and mildew; these will pursue you until you perish. [23] The sky over your head will be bronze, and the earth beneath you iron. [24] The LORD will turn the rain of your land into

dust and powder; it will descend on you from the sky until you are destroyed. [25] The LORD will cause you to be defeated before your enemies. You will march out against them in one direction but flee from them in seven. You will be an object of horror to all the kingdoms of the earth. [26] Your corpses will be food for all the birds of the air and beasts of the earth, with no one to scare them away. [27] The LORD will afflict you with the boils of Egypt, with tumors and scabs and itch from which you cannot be cured. [28] The LORD will afflict you with madness, blindness, and confusion of mind, [29] and at noon you will grope about like a blind man in the darkness. You will not prosper in your ways. Day after day you will be oppressed and plundered, with no one to save you. [30] You will be pledged in marriage to a woman, but another man will violate her. You will build a house but will not live in it. You will plant a vineyard but will not enjoy its fruit. [31] Your ox will be slaughtered before your eyes, but you will not eat any of it. Your donkey will be taken away and not returned to you. Your flock will be given to your enemies, and no one will save you. [32] Your sons and daughters will be given to another nation, while your eyes grow weary looking for them day after day, with no power in your hand. [33] A people you do not know will eat the produce of your land and of all your toil. All your days you will be oppressed and crushed. [34] You will be driven mad by the sights you see. [35] The LORD will afflict you with painful, incurable boils on your knees and thighs, from the soles of your feet to the top of your head. [36] The LORD will bring you and the king you appoint to a nation neither you nor your fathers have known, and there you will worship other gods—gods of wood and stone. [37] You will become an object of horror, scorn, and ridicule among all the nations to which the LORD will drive you. [38] You will sow much seed in the field but harvest little, because the locusts will consume it. [39] You will plant and cultivate vineyards, but will neither drink the wine nor gather the grapes, because worms will eat them. [40] You will have olive trees throughout your territory but will never anoint yourself with oil, because the olives will drop off. [41] You will father sons and daughters, but they will not remain yours, because they will go into captivity. [42] Swarms of locusts will consume all your trees and the produce of your land. [43] The foreigner living among you will rise higher and higher above you, while you sink down lower and lower. [44] He will lend to you, but you will not lend to him. He will be the head, and you will be the tail.

[45] All these curses will come upon you. They will pursue you and overtake you until you are destroyed, since you did not obey the LORD your God and keep the commandments and statutes He gave you. [46] These curses will be a sign and a wonder upon you and your descendants forever. [47] Because you did not serve the LORD your God with joy and gladness of heart in all your abundance, [48] you will serve your enemies the LORD will send against you in famine, thirst, nakedness, and destitution. He will place an iron yoke on your neck until He has destroyed you. [49] The LORD will bring a nation from afar, from the ends of the earth, to swoop down upon you like an eagle—a nation whose language you will not understand, [50] a ruthless nation with no respect for the old and no pity for the young. [51] They will eat the offspring of your livestock and the produce of your land until you are destroyed. They will leave you no grain or new wine or oil, no calves of your herds or lambs of your flocks, until they have caused you to perish. [52] They will besiege all the cities throughout your land, until the high and fortified walls in which you trust have fallen. They will besiege all your cities throughout the land that the LORD your God has given you. [53] Then you will eat the fruit of your womb, the flesh of the sons and daughters whom the LORD your God has given you, in the siege and distress that your enemy will inflict on you. [54] The most gentle and refined man among you will begrudge his brother, the wife he embraces, and the rest of his children who have survived, [55] refusing to share with any of them the flesh of his children he will eat because he has nothing left in the siege and distress that your enemy will inflict on you within all your gates. [56] The most gentle and refined woman among you, so gentle and refined she would not venture to set the sole of her foot on the ground, will begrudge the husband she embraces and her son and daughter [57] the afterbirth that comes from between her legs and the children she bears, because she will secretly eat them for lack of anything else in the siege and distress that your enemy will inflict on you within your gates. [58] If you are not careful to observe all the words of this law which are written in this book, that you may fear this glorious and awesome name—the LORD your God— [59] He will bring upon you and your descendants extraordinary disasters, severe and lasting plagues, and terrible and chronic sicknesses. [60] He will afflict you again with all the diseases you dreaded in Egypt, and they will cling to you. [61] The LORD will also bring upon you every sickness and plague not recorded in this Book of the Law, until you are destroyed. [62] You who were as numerous as the stars in the sky will be left few in number, because you would not obey the voice of the LORD your God. [63] Just as it pleased the LORD to make you prosper and multiply, so also it will please Him to annihilate you and destroy you. And you will be uprooted from the land you are entering to possess. [64] Then the LORD will scatter you among all the nations, from one end of the earth to the other, and there you will worship other gods, gods of wood and stone, which neither you nor your fathers have known. [65] Among those nations you will find no repose, not even a resting place for the sole of your foot. There the LORD will give you a trembling heart, failing eyes, and a despairing soul. [66] So your life will hang in doubt before you, and you will be afraid night and day, never certain of survival. [67] In the morning you will say, 'If only it were evening!' and in the evening you will say, 'If only it were morning!'—because of the dread in your hearts of the terrifying sights you will see. [68] "The LORD will return you to Egypt in ships by a route that I said you should never see again. There you will sell yourselves to your enemies as male and female slaves, but no one will buy you."

**29** These are the words of the covenant that the LORD commanded Moses to make with the Israelites in the land of Moab, in addition to the covenant He had made with them at Horeb. [2] Moses summoned all Israel and proclaimed to them, "You have seen with your own eyes everything the LORD did in Egypt to Pharaoh, to all his officials, and to all his land." [3] You saw with your own eyes the great trials, and those miraculous signs and wonders. [4] Yet to this day the LORD has not given you a mind to understand, eyes to see, or ears to hear. [5] For forty years I led you in the wilderness, yet your clothes and sandals did not wear out. [6] You ate no bread and drank no wine or strong drink, so that you might know that I am the LORD your God. [7] When you reached this place, Sihon king of Heshbon and Og king of Bashan came out against us in battle, but we defeated them. [8] We took their land and gave it as an inheritance to the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh.

[9] So keep and follow the words of this covenant, that you may prosper in all you do. [10] All of you are standing today before the LORD your God—you leaders of tribes, elders, officials, and all the men of Israel, [11] your children and wives, and the foreigners in your camps who cut your wood and draw your water— [12] so that you may enter into the covenant of the LORD your God, which He is making with you today, and into His oath, [13] and so that He may establish you today as His people, and He may be your God as He promised you and as He swore to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

[14] I am making this covenant and this oath not only with you, [15] but also with those who are standing here with us today in the presence of the LORD our God, as well as with those who are not here today. [16] For you yourselves know how we lived in the land of Egypt and how we passed through the nations on the way here. [17] You saw the abominations and idols among them made of wood and stone, of silver and gold. [18] Make sure there is no man or woman, clan or tribe among you today whose heart turns away from the LORD our God to go and worship the gods of those nations. Make sure there is no root among you that bears such poisonous and bitter fruit, [19] because when such a person hears the words of this oath, he invokes a blessing on himself, saying, 'I will have peace, even though I walk in the stubbornness of my own heart.' This will bring disaster on the watered land as well as the dry. [20] The LORD will never be willing to forgive him. Instead, His anger and jealousy will burn against that man, and every curse written in this book will fall upon him. The LORD will blot out his name from under heaven [21] and single him out from all the tribes of Israel for disaster, according to all the curses of the covenant written in this Book of the Law. [22] Then the generation to come—your sons who follow you and the foreigner who comes from a distant land—will see the plagues of the land and the sicknesses the LORD has inflicted on it. [23] All its soil will be a burning waste of sulfur and salt, unsown and unproductive, with no plant growing on it, just like the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboiim, which the LORD overthrew in His fierce anger. [24] So all the nations will ask, 'Why has the LORD done such a thing to this land? Why this great outburst of anger?' [25] And the people will answer, 'It is because they abandoned the covenant of the LORD, the God of their fathers, which He made with them when He brought them out of the land of Egypt.' [26] They went and served other gods, and they worshiped gods they had not known—gods that the LORD had not given to them. [27] Therefore the anger of the LORD burned against this land, and He brought upon it every curse written in this book. [28] The LORD uprooted them from their land in His anger, rage, and great wrath, and He cast them into another land, where they are today.' [29] The secret things belong to the LORD our God, but the things revealed belong to us and to our children forever, so that we may follow all the words of this law.

**30** "When all these things come upon you—the blessings and curses I have set before you—and you call them to mind in all the nations to which the LORD your God has banished you," [2] and when you and your children return to the LORD your God and obey His voice with all your heart and all your soul according to everything I am giving you today, [3] then He will restore you from captivity and have compassion on you and gather you from all the nations to which the LORD your God has scattered you. [4] Even if you have been banished to the farthest horizon, He will gather you and return you from there. [5] And the LORD your God will bring you into the land your fathers possessed, and you will take possession of it. He will cause you to prosper and multiply more than your fathers. [6] The LORD your God will circumcise your hearts and the hearts of your descendants, and you will love Him with all your heart and with all your soul, so that you may live. [7] Then the LORD your God will put all these curses upon your enemies who hate you and persecute you. [8] And you will again obey the voice of the LORD and follow all His commandments I am giving you today. [9] So the LORD your God will make you abound in all the work of your hands and in the fruit of your womb, the offspring of your livestock, and the produce of your land. Indeed, the LORD will again delight in your goodness, as He delighted in that of your fathers, [10] if you obey the LORD your God by keeping His commandments and statutes that are written in this Book of the Law, and if you turn to Him with all your heart and with all your soul.

[11] For this commandment I give you today is not too difficult for you or beyond your reach. [12] It is not in heaven, that you should need to ask, 'Who will ascend

into heaven to get it for us and proclaim it, that we may obey it?' [13] And it is not beyond the sea, that you should need to ask, 'Who will cross the sea to get it for us and proclaim it, that we may obey it?' [14] But the word is very near you; it is in your mouth and in your heart, so that you may obey it. [15] See, I have set before you today life and goodness, as well as death and disaster. [16] For I am commanding you today to love the LORD your God, to walk in His ways, and to keep His commandments, statutes, and ordinances, so that you may live and increase, and the LORD your God may bless you in the land that you are entering to possess. [17] But if your heart turns away and you do not listen, but are drawn away to bow down to other gods and worship them, [18] I declare to you today that you will surely perish; you shall not prolong your days in the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess. [19] I call heaven and earth as witnesses against you today that I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing. Therefore choose life, so that you and your descendants may live, [20] "and that you may love the LORD your God, obey Him, and hold fast to Him. For He is your life, and He will prolong your life in the land that the LORD swore to give to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob."

**31** When Moses had finished speaking these words to all Israel, [2] he said to them, "I am now a hundred and twenty years old; I am no longer able to come and go, and the LORD has said to me, 'You shall not cross the Jordan.'" [3] The LORD your God Himself will cross over ahead of you. He will destroy these nations before you, and you will dispossess them. Joshua will cross ahead of you, as the LORD has said. [4] And the LORD will do to them as He did to Sihon and Og, the kings of the Amorites, when He destroyed them along with their land. [5] The LORD will deliver them over to you, and you must do to them exactly as I have commanded you. [6] "Be strong and courageous; do not be afraid or terrified of them, for it is the LORD your God who goes with you; He will never leave you nor forsake you." [7] Then Moses called for Joshua and said to him in the presence of all Israel, "Be strong and courageous, for you will go with this people into the land that the LORD swore to their fathers to give them, and you shall give it to them as an inheritance." [8] "The LORD Himself goes before you; He will be with you. He will never leave you nor forsake you. Do not be afraid or discouraged." [9] So Moses wrote down this law and gave it to the priests, the sons of Levi, who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and to all the elders of Israel.

[10] Then Moses commanded them, "At the end of every seven years, at the appointed time in the year of remission of debt, during the Feast of Tabernacles," [11] when all Israel comes before the LORD your God at the place He will choose, you are to read this law in the hearing of all Israel. [12] Assemble the people—men, women, children, and the foreigners within your gates—so that they may listen and learn to fear the LORD your God and to follow carefully all the words of this law. [13] "Then their children who do not know the law will listen and learn to fear the LORD your God, as long as you live in the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess."

[14] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Behold, the time of your death is near. Call Joshua and present yourselves at the Tent of Meeting, so that I may commission him." So Moses and Joshua went and presented themselves at the Tent of Meeting. [15] Then the LORD appeared at the tent in a pillar of cloud, and the cloud stood over the entrance to the tent. [16] And the LORD said to Moses, "You will soon rest with your fathers, and these people will rise up and prostitute themselves with the foreign gods of the land they are entering. They will forsake Me and break the covenant I have made with them." [17] On that day My anger will burn against them, and I will abandon them and hide My face from them, so that they will be consumed, and many troubles and afflictions will befall them. On that day they will say, 'Have not these disasters come upon us because our God is no longer with us?' [18] And on that day I will surely hide My face because of all the evil they have done by turning to other gods. [19] Now therefore, write down for yourselves this song and teach it to the Israelites; have them recite it, so that it may be a witness for Me against them.

[20] When I have brought them into the land that I swore to give their fathers, a land flowing with milk and honey, they will eat their fill and prosper. Then they will turn to other gods and worship them, and they will reject Me and break My covenant. [21] "And when many troubles and afflictions have come upon them, this song will testify against them, because it will not be forgotten from the lips of their descendants. For I know their inclination, even before I bring them into the land that I swore to give them." [22] So that very day Moses wrote down this song and taught it to the Israelites. [23] Then the LORD commissioned Joshua son of Nun and said, "Be strong and courageous, for you will bring the Israelites into the land that I swore to give them, and I will be with you." [24] When Moses had finished writing in a book the words of this law from beginning to end, [25] he gave this command to the Levites who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD: [26] "Take this Book of the Law and place it beside the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, so that it may remain there as a witness against you." [27] For I know how rebellious and stiff-necked you are. If you are already rebelling against the LORD while I am still alive, how much more will you rebel after my death! [28] Assemble before me all the elders of your tribes and all your officers so that I may speak these words in their hearing and call heaven and earth to witness against them. [29] "For I know that after my death you will become utterly corrupt and turn from the path I have commanded you. And in the days to come, disaster will befall you because you will do evil in the sight of the LORD to provoke Him to anger by the work of your hands." [30] Then Moses recited aloud to the whole assembly of Israel the words of this song from beginning to end:

**32** Give ear, O heavens, and I will speak; hear, O earth, the words of my mouth. [2] Let my teaching fall like rain and my speech settle like dew, like gentle rain on new grass, like showers on tender plants. [3] For I will proclaim the name of the LORD. Ascribe greatness to our God! [4] He is the Rock, His work is perfect; all His ways are just. A God of faithfulness without injustice, righteous and upright is He. [5] His people have acted corruptly toward Him; the spot on them is not that of His children, but of a perverse and crooked generation. [6] Is this how you repay the LORD, O foolish and senseless people? Is He not your Father and Creator? Has He not made you and established you? [7] Remember the days of old; consider the years long past. Ask your father, and he will tell you, your elders, and they will inform you. [8] When the Most High gave the nations their inheritance, when He divided the sons of man, He set the boundaries of the peoples according to the number of the sons of God. [9] But the LORD's portion is His people, Jacob His allotted inheritance. [10] He found him in a desert land, in a barren, howling wilderness; He surrounded him, He instructed him, He guarded him as the apple of His eye. [11] As an eagle stirs up its nest and hovers over its young, He spread His wings to catch them and carried them on His pinions. [12] The LORD alone led him, and no foreign god was with him. [13] He made him ride on the heights of the land and fed him the produce of the field. He nourished him with honey from the rock and oil from the flinty crag, [14] with curds from the herd and milk from the flock, with the fat of lambs, with rams from Bashan, and goats, with the choicest grains of wheat. From the juice of the finest grapes you drank the wine. [15] But Jeshurun grew fat and kicked— becoming fat, bloated, and gorged. He abandoned the God who made him and scorned the Rock of his salvation. [16] They provoked His jealousy with foreign gods; they enraged Him with abominations.

[17] They sacrificed to demons, not to God, to gods they had not known, to newly arrived gods, which your fathers did not fear. [18] You ignored the Rock who brought you forth; you forgot the God who gave you birth. [19] When the LORD saw this, He rejected them, provoked to anger by His sons and daughters. [20] He said: "I will hide My face from them; I will see what will be their end. For they are a perverse generation— children of unfaithfulness." [21] They have provoked My jealousy by that which is not God; they have enraged Me with their worthless idols. So I will make them jealous by those who are not a people; I will make them angry by a nation without understanding.

[22] For a fire has been kindled by My anger, and it burns to the depths of Sheol; it consumes the earth and its produce, and scorches the foundations of the mountains. [23] I will heap disasters upon them; I will spend My arrows against them. [24] They will be wasted from hunger and ravaged by pestilence and bitter plague; I will send the fangs of wild beasts against them, with the venom of vipers that slither in the dust. [25] Outside, the sword will take their children, and inside, terror will strike the young man and the young woman, the infant and the gray-haired man. [26] I would have said that I would cut them to pieces and blot out their memory from mankind, [27] "if I had not dreaded the taunt of the enemy, lest their adversaries misunderstand and say: 'Our own hand has prevailed; it was not the LORD who did all this.'" [28] Israel is a nation devoid of counsel, with no understanding among them. [29] If only they were wise, they would understand it; they would comprehend their fate. [30] How could one man pursue a thousand, or two put ten thousand to flight, unless their Rock had sold them, unless the LORD had given them up? [31] For their rock is not like our Rock, even our enemies concede. [32] But their vine is from the vine of Sodom and from the fields of Gomorrah. Their grapes are poisonous; their clusters are bitter. [33] Their wine is the venom of serpents, the deadly poison of cobras.

[34] "Have I not stored up these things, sealed up within My vaults?" [35] "Vengeance is Mine; I will repay. In due time their foot will slip; for their day of disaster is near, and their doom is coming quickly." [36] For the LORD will vindicate His people and have compassion on His servants when He sees that their strength is gone and no one remains, slave or free. [37] He will say: "Where are their gods, the rock in which they took refuge," [38] which ate the fat of their sacrifices and drank the wine of their drink offerings? Let them rise up and help you; let them give you shelter! [39] See now that I am He; there is no God besides Me. I bring death and I give life; I wound and I heal, and there is no one who can deliver from My hand. [40] For I lift up My hand to heaven and declare: As surely as I live forever, [41] when I sharpen My flashing sword, and My hand grasps it in judgment, I will take vengeance on My adversaries and repay those who hate Me. [42] "I will make My arrows drunk with blood, while My sword devours flesh— the blood of the slain and captives, the heads of the enemy leaders." [43] Rejoice, O heavens, with Him, and let all God's angels worship Him. Rejoice, O nations, with His people; for He will avenge the blood of His children. He will take vengeance on His adversaries and repay those who hate Him; He will cleanse His land and His people. [44] Then Moses came with Joshua son of Nun and recited all the words of this song in the hearing of the people. [45] When Moses had finished reciting all these words to all Israel, [46] he said to them, "Take to heart all these words I testify among you today, so that you may command your children to carefully follow all the words of this law." [47] "For they are not idle words to you, because they are your life, and by them you will live long in the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess." [48] On that same day the LORD said to Moses, [49] "Go up into the Abarim Range to Mount Nebo, in the land of Moab across from Jericho, and view the land of

Canaan, which I am giving to the Israelites as their own possession." [50] And there on the mountain that you climb, you will die and be gathered to your people, just as your brother Aaron died on Mount Hor and was gathered to his people. [51] For at the waters of Meribah-kadesh in the Wilderness of Zin, both of you broke faith with Me among the Israelites by failing to treat Me as holy in their presence. [52] "Although you shall see from a distance the land that I am giving the Israelites, you shall not enter it."

**33** This is the blessing that Moses the man of God pronounced upon the Israelites before his death. [2] He said: "The LORD came from Sinai and dawned upon us from Seir; He shone forth from Mount Paran and came with myriads of holy ones, with flaming fire at His right hand." [3] Surely You love the people; all the holy ones are in Your hand, and they sit down at Your feet; each receives Your words— [4] the law that Moses gave us, the possession of the assembly of Jacob. [5] So the LORD became King in Jeshurun when the leaders of the people gathered, when the tribes of Israel came together. [6] "Let Reuben live and not die, nor his men be few." [7] And concerning Judah he said: "O LORD, hear the cry of Judah and bring him to his people. With his own hands he defends his cause, but may You be a help against his foes." [8] Concerning Levi he said: "Give Your Thummim to Levi and Your Urim to Your godly one, whom You tested at Massah and contested at the waters of Meribah."

[9] He said of his father and mother, 'I do not consider them.' He disregarded his brothers and did not know his own sons, for he kept Your word and maintained Your covenant. [10] He will teach Your ordinances to Jacob and Your law to Israel; he will set incense before You and whole burnt offerings on Your altar. [11] "Bless his substance, O LORD, and accept the work of his hands. Smash the loins of those who rise against him, and of his foes so they can rise no more." [12] Concerning Benjamin he said: "May the beloved of the LORD rest secure in Him; God shields him all day long, and upon His shoulders he rests."

[13] Concerning Joseph he said: "May his land be blessed by the LORD with the precious dew from heaven above and the deep waters that lie beneath," [14] with the bountiful harvest from the sun and the abundant yield of the seasons, [15] with the best of the ancient mountains and the bounty of the everlasting hills, [16] with the choice gifts of the land and everything in it, and with the favor of Him who dwelt in the burning bush. May these rest on the head of Joseph and crown the brow of the prince of his brothers. [17] "His majesty is like a firstborn bull, and his horns are like those of a wild ox. With them he will gore the nations, even to the ends of the earth. Such are the myriads of Ephraim, and such are the thousands of Manasseh." [18] Concerning Zebulun he said: "Rejoice, Zebulun, in your journeys, and Issachar, in your tents."

[19] "They will call the peoples to a mountain; there they will offer sacrifices of righteousness. For they will feast on the abundance of the seas and the hidden treasures of the sand." [20] Concerning Gad he said: "Blessed is he who enlarges the domain of Gad! He lies down like a lion and tears off an arm or a head." [21] "He chose the best land for himself, because a ruler's portion was reserved for him there. He came with the leaders of the people; he administered the LORD's justice and His ordinances for Israel." [22] Concerning Dan he said: "Dan is a lion's cub, leaping out of Bashan." [23] Concerning Naphtali he said: "Naphtali is abounding with favor, full of the blessing of the LORD; he shall take possession of the sea and the south." [24] And concerning Asher he said: "May Asher be the most blessed of sons; may he be the most favored among his brothers and dip his foot in oil." [25] "May the bolts of your gate be iron and bronze, and may your strength match your days." [26] "There is none like the God of Jeshurun, who rides the heavens to your aid, and the clouds in His majesty." [27] The eternal God is your dwelling place, and underneath are the everlasting arms. He drives out the enemy before you, giving the command, 'Destroy him!' [28] So Israel dwells securely; the fountain of Jacob lives untroubled in a land of grain and new wine, where even the heavens drip with dew. [29] "Blessed are you, O Israel! Who is like you, a people saved by the LORD? He is the shield that protects you, the sword in which you boast. Your enemies will cower before you, and you shall trample their high places."

**34** Then Moses went up from the plains of Moab to Mount Nebo, to the top of Pisgah, which faces Jericho. And the LORD showed him the whole land— from Gilead as far as Dan, [2] all of Naphtali, the land of Ephraim and Manasseh, all the land of Judah as far as the Western Sea, [3] the Negev, and the region from the Valley of Jericho (the City of Palms) all the way to Zoar. [4] And the LORD said to him, "This is the land that I swore to give Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob when I said, 'I will give it to your descendants.' I have let you see it with your own eyes, but you will not cross into it." [5] So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, as the LORD had said. [6] And He buried him in a valley in the land of Moab facing Beth-peor, and no one to this day knows the location of his grave. [7] Moses was a hundred and twenty years old when he died, yet his eyes were not weak, and his vitality had not diminished. [8] The Israelites grieved for Moses in the plains of Moab thirty days, until the time of weeping and mourning for Moses came to an end. [9] Now Joshua son of Nun was filled with the spirit of wisdom because Moses had laid his hands on him. So the Israelites obeyed him and did as the LORD had commanded Moses. [10] Since that time, no prophet has risen in Israel like Moses, whom the LORD knew face to face— [11] no prophet who did all the signs and wonders that the LORD sent Moses to do in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh and to all his officials and all his land, [12] and no prophet who performed all the mighty acts of power and awesome deeds that Moses did in the sight of all Israel.

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